Now let us compare the three types of conflicts.

In *war*, the sides use the entire arsenal at their disposal, with the goal of conquering or liberating territory. Conventional wars are on the decline, and alongside them a new type of conflict has developed called “low-intensity warfare” or “asymmetric warfare” (though these two things are not necessarily exactly the same).

In *terrorism,* the use of weapons is very limited but extremely lethal. The goal of terrorism is to change a regime, to liberate a nation, or, in the case of international jihadist terrorism, to establish a global Islamic caliphate. The phenomenon of terrorism of all kinds is constantly on the rise.

In *guerrilla warfare*, the use of weapons is limited. The goal is to liberate occupied territory and change the regime, and the top civilian echelons of the state, alongside all uniformed people, are viewed as legitimate targets. Guerrilla warfare has also been on the increase along the time line of history.

A comparison between classical terrorism and its modern incarnation reveals the following significant distinctions.

- First of all, classical terrorism was *local,* covering the territory of a particular region or country, but not more. Modern terrorism is *global*.
- Classical terrorism was *secular;* although in the Middle East today there are still some traces of terrorist groups whose leaders were or are Christian Arabs, modern terrorism is *religious-Muslim- fundamentalist.*
- Classical terrorism was *nationalistic,* striving to achieve self-determination, whereas contemporary terrorism can be defined as *imperialistic* in the sense that it aspires to create a Muslim world that lives according to the laws of sharia (Islamic law).
- Solidarity in the era of classical terrorism existed between secular territorial groups. Solidarity today is a function of the global religious common denominator. The classical terrorist organizations had *socialist or Marxist* political tendencies, as opposed to today’s groups, which follow *Islamic theology.*
- Classical terrorism had a *weak, mostly local, resonance.* Contemporary terrorism has a strong, real-time *global resonance,* and it gets it for free.